

ALAN PONTON

UX / Product Designer · Designs and Ships

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SUMMARY

Product-minded UX designer who owns the full arc: research, information architecture, interaction and visual design, and the production build. I design for real users under real constraints, ship, and iterate. Two end-to-end case studies carry the story. One is a productized travel platform built under severe constraint. The other is a security operations tool taken through three documented versions. Google UX Design and Meta Front-End certified. AI-augmented development is my force multiplier. It lets one designer carry an idea from research to a live, maintained product.

SELECTED DESIGN WORK

Lonnie's Locations — Productized Group-Travel Platform · UX Designer & Full-Stack Developer (solo) Dec 2025 – Present

End-to-end product design and build for an independent travel advisor with a thriving high-touch business and zero digital infrastructure. Live in production serving real guests.

- Mined the advisor's inbox as a qualitative dataset (no research budget) to derive the recurring question taxonomy that became the AI knowledge base and FAQ architecture.
- Caught and reversed my own designer-imposition failure. I had designed an aspirational itinerary over the client's actual chosen plans, and made "design for who the user is, not who I assume they should be" a governing principle.
- Designed an AI travel concierge as a conversation-design problem first: trip-aware persona, suggested-question chips to lower the blank-prompt barrier, streaming for perceived performance, and deliberate refusal boundaries on pricing, medical, and refund questions.
- Identified the human-escalation banner as a trust-integrity defect (it promised a follow-up the system never sent) and designed the closed loop: real-time admin dashboard, color-coded urgency, transcript context, proactive contact capture.
- Designed structurally distinct reservation flows matched to each trip's mental model, plus a passwordless guest portal with status microcopy that converts database states into emotional reassurance. Accessibility treated as a premium feature for an older, mobile-first audience.

2100 Security — Security Operations Platform · UX Designer & Full-Stack Developer (solo) 2024 – Present

A progressive web app I designed and built for the five-person overnight security team I work with at a 33-floor Dallas high-rise. Replaced a broken no-SSL legacy site; evolved across three production versions, in nightly use.

- Derived design constraints from direct observation of officers using the old site in real conditions (low light, one-handed, mid-patrol), turning friction points into hard requirements: dark-by-default, high-contrast, no horizontal scroll.
- V1 to V2 self-correction: my own visually-impressive dark theme tested as unreadable on a long shift. I reversed it, stripping styling back and prioritizing readability over aesthetics based on user feedback.
- Designed the access model around a governing principle drawn from a failed chat-tool rollout ("zero-friction access beats feature richness"): a passwordless guard-picker identity layer with no email, no app store, under five seconds.
- Inverse design judgment: deliberately added friction, employee-ID re-entry to confirm fire-extinguisher inspections, because a careless tap on a safety record is real-world harm, not a UI annoyance.
- Constraint-based scheduling engine honoring 5 to 7 simultaneous rules; rebuilt the data architecture after a decoupling bug, adopting incremental single-transformation validation as a method.

Additional Shipped Products · Solo, AI-augmented 2025 – Present

- MetroPlex Match: compatibility-first dating platform (205+ users); product framing of "optimize for compatibility, not swipes."
- Trip Buddy: AI travel companion with a modular wardrobe/outfit system and voice concierge; built over 14 sessions and used personally on a real cruise.
- Push Coach: SMS accountability coaching. FollowThisModel: AI-twin communication platform with beta users. Sophia AI: the voice-first assistant foundation behind several products.

CAPABILITIES

Frontend

React, TypeScript, Next.js, Tailwind CSS, Framer Motion, GSAP, responsive design

Backend & APIs	Node.js, Express, Supabase, PostgreSQL, REST APIs, edge functions, webhooks
AI & ML	Anthropic Claude API, OpenAI API, prompt engineering, AI agents, RAG, vector search, n8n AI workflows
Infrastructure	Cloudflare (Pages/DNS/Workers), Supabase Auth & Storage, DNS management, CI/CD, GitHub, Vercel
Design	User research framing, information architecture, interaction & visual design, conversation/AI UX, content strategy & microcopy, accessibility (WCAG, reduced-motion), wireframing, prototyping, usability iteration
Approach	Constraint-driven product design, AI-augmented full-stack delivery, ship-measure-iterate

CREDENTIALS & EXPERIENCE

- **Google UX Design Professional Certificate** · Coursera, 2022
- **Meta Front-End Developer Professional Certificate** · Coursera, 2024
- In progress: IBM AI Engineering · Microsoft AI-900 · AWS credentials
- **Network Administrator, State of New Jersey** · 2005–2019 · 14+ years enterprise/government IT and infrastructure
- **Application Developer, Experian (Fortune 500)** · 1998–2003 · enterprise data-processing systems